

Look, Placer.ai-hiring-person,

I'm going to be straight with ya': nothing's special about Placer.ai. I could have AI write this up, telling you I'm the perfect candidate because of X - the same cover letter you've seen 100 other times. The truth is, you didn't stand out. Your posting had the same techs as every other posting - Claude-Code, fastAPI/Python, Typescript. The same missions - move fast, AI-native. Same Dental/401K/PTO benefits.

If you're looking for someone who "Has dreamed of working on a location intelligence platform since they were just a few stem cells big," I'm not that guy.

I AM the guy who loves building things in code. I'm un-particular about the details. I love building with AI/Claude-Code/Agents, and without. I love building in React, or Astro, or even native JS. I love working on the frontend, and working on data pipelines. Even the system doesn't matter: I'll work on Windows, Linux, anything. It doesn't even really matter WHAT I'm building - if something needs building in code, I'll build it. It's what I'm best at, where I learn the most, what I like in life.

Your needs are the same as everyone else's. A high-ownership engineer. Deep experience in X. Ships complete products that customers will love. Insert a fourth copy/paste from the job app here, etc, etc. That's, like, a 20% interest for me right now; that would jump to 120% in a flash if I were actually Building your product. The more I invest in building stuff for Placer.ai the "special-er" it gets.

If you need the love-at-first-read applicant, skip me; if you're looking for a more stable kind of love - the long love of an engineer for building stuff of any shape - reach out.

Cheers,

- Sander VanWilligen